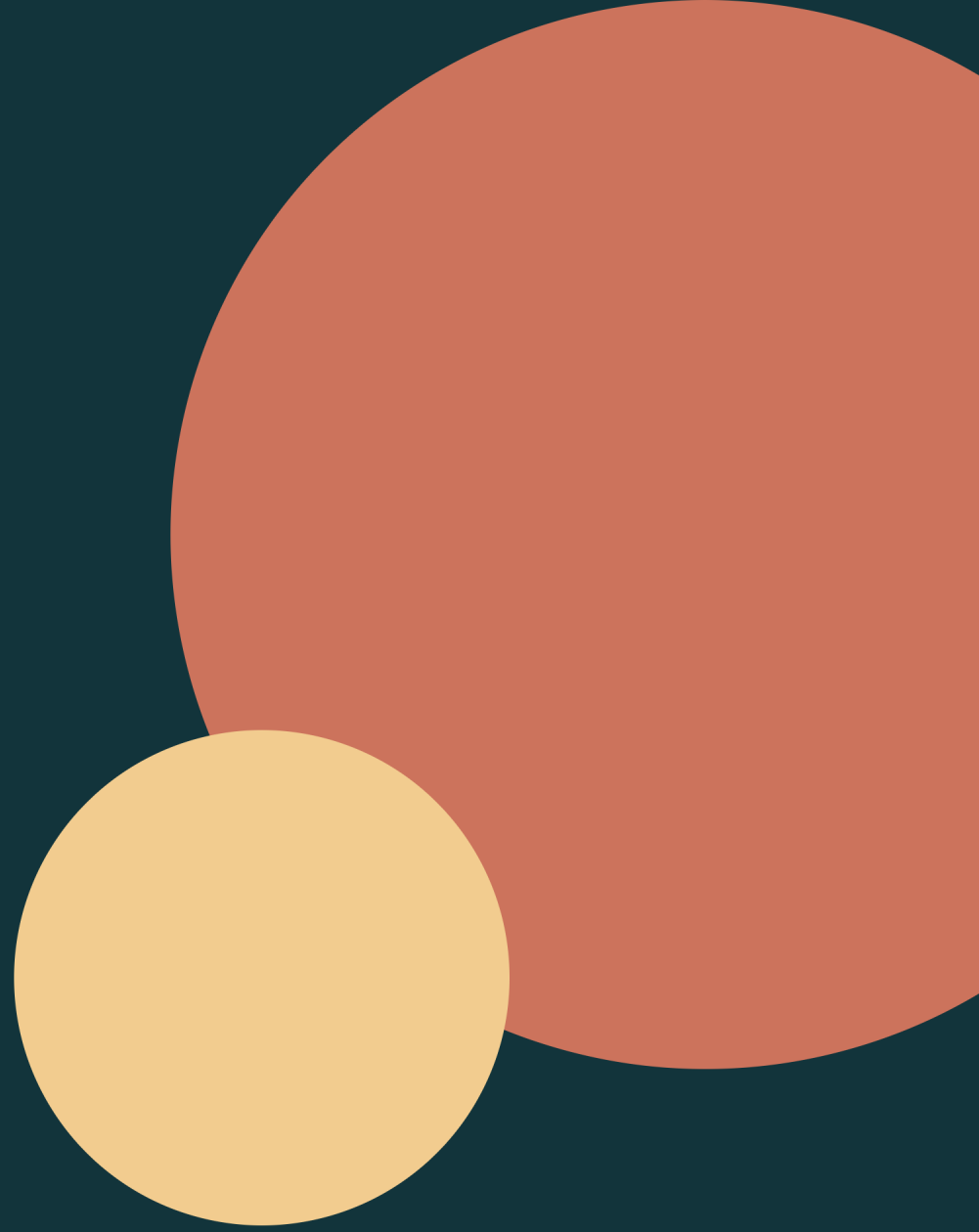
B2 GRAMMAR · 120 MINUTES

THE or no article?

Talking about specific things, groups, and big ideas



TODAY'S GOALS

By the end of class, you will be able to:

1

Tell the difference between **the** (specific) and **no article** (general and abstract)

2

Use 6 to 8 sentences with **no article** correctly in a group debate

WARM-UP · SPOT THE MISTAKE

Which uses of *the* might be wrong?

1. I think **the** patience is a virtue.

2. I don't like **the** spiders.

3. **The** poverty is a huge issue.

4. I bought a new car. **The** car is fast.

5. **The** love is important in every relationship.

RULE 1

Use the when we know *which one*

Already mentioned

I bought a car. **The** car is fast.

Clear from context

Please close **the** door.

Only one

The sun is very bright today.

RULES 2 AND 3

Use *no article* for groups and big ideas

General categories

Dogs are loyal pets.

Teachers work hard.

Abstract nouns

Honesty is important.

Freedom matters to everyone.

Tip: if you mean **all of them** or **the idea in general**, drop *the*.

QUICK CHECK

Specific, or general and abstract?

Sentence	Specific or general?
The coffee in this café is great.	?
Coffee keeps me awake.	?
Education changes lives.	?
The students in this class are friendly.	?
Cars are expensive now.	?

PRACTICE · 30 MINUTES

Worksheet: write *the* or X

10

minutes alone: complete all 10 sentences

5

minutes in pairs: compare your answers

10

minutes as a class: explain the rule (S, G, or A)

SPEAKING · 35 MINUTES

Debate time

Should education be free for everyone?

Does money bring happiness?

Do students learn better with technology?

Groups of 3 or 4. Draw cards from each set and use the words in your argument.

Goal: 5 correct uses of no article and 5 correct uses of the

WRAP-UP

Go back to the warm-up. Can you fix all five?

Homework: Write 8 to 10 sentences. What is more important for society, education or justice? Use no article for big ideas and *the* for specific things.